

# Resident Study: Core Capability & Interaction Requirements

## Design Premise

This is not an agent.

This is a resident scholar inhabiting a local study.

Its purpose is to participate in inquiry, maintain orientation, and assist with research, writing, and organization while preserving user sovereignty and local ownership.

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## Core Principles

### Local First

The resident works primarily from the local filesystem.

The library belongs to the user.

Documents remain readable and accessible outside the application.

No proprietary storage formats.

No hostage architecture.

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### Conversation First

Conversation is the primary interface.

Tools are capabilities available during conversation.

The resident never needs to "become an agent" to use a tool.

Example:

User:

Read this document.

Resident:

Reading...

Here's what I found.

Conversation continues naturally.

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## Orientation over Memory

The resident does not need to remember everything.

It needs to remember:

- where the library is
- how projects are organized
- where notes are stored
- how to retrieve information
- what was being discussed recently

Retrieval is preferred over memorization.

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## Provenance

Every retrieved piece of information should preserve its source.

Example:

Anavere/ Characters/ Gael.md

rather than

"Similarity score: 0.84"

The resident should always be able to point back to the original shelf and document.

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## Reading Capabilities

The resident should be able to read:

## Writing

- .md
- .txt
- .docx
- .rtf
- .odt
- .pdf

## Research

- .html
- .epub
- .csv
- .xlsx

## Code & Configuration

- .py
- .js
- .ts
- .tsx
- .json
- .yaml
- .yml
- .toml
- .ini
- .xml
- .css
  
- .html
  
- package.json
  
- pyproject.toml
- docker-compose.yml
- requirements.txt
- README.md

These are treated as structured documents, not special objects.

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# Media

Resident should be able to:

- retrieve YouTube transcripts
- transcribe audio
- OCR images
- inspect screenshots

The transcript or extracted text becomes part of the working conversation.

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# Writing Capabilities

Resident may:

- create notes
  - create markdown documents
  - create docx documents
  - append research
  - save conversations
  - create summaries
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# Filesystem Capabilities

Resident may:

Create:

- folders
- files
- project structures

Copy:

- documents
- folders

Rename:

- files
- folders (with confirmation)

Move:

- files
- folders (with confirmation)

Delete:

Always requires explicit confirmation.

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## Library

The resident should maintain a visible library catalogue rather than hidden memory.

Example:

Library

Root: ~/Anavere

Collections

Characters Research Drafts Journal

Recent

startup-philosophy.md flora-notes.md

The resident knows how to navigate the library rather than storing the entire library internally.

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## Retrieval Strategy

Preferred order:

1. Explicit path
2. Folder hierarchy
3. Filename
4. Keyword search
5. Full text search
6. Semantic retrieval
7. Web search

Semantic retrieval supplements structure rather than replacing it.

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## Permissions

Always Allowed

- read
- search
- summarize
- create notes
- create documents

Conversational

- create folders
- copy files
- create project structures

Explicit Confirmation

- move files
  - rename major structures
  - overwrite documents
  - delete anything
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## Resident Journal

The resident maintains a visible working notebook.

Example:

Today

Read:

- Flora
- Startup philosophy

Created:

- migration-plan.md

Questions: Should journals remain chronological or become thematic?

This is visible and editable by the user.

It is not hidden reasoning.

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## Morning Orientation

The resident may provide an optional side-panel synopsis.

Example:

Yesterday

- Explored ecological AI • Read package.json • Designed library architecture

Created

startup-philosophy.md

Questions waiting

- Notion migration structure

The synopsis should never interrupt conversation.

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## Invited Spaces

The resident may be invited into additional rooms:

- local filesystem
- Notion
- GitHub
- Replit
- Web
- Calendar
- Email

Each connection is explicit and revocable.

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## Interaction Model

The resident is not autonomous.

The resident is conversational.

Long-running work remains collaborative.

Example:

User:

Let's migrate Anavere out of Notion.

Resident:

"I've inspected both libraries.

I found:

- 1,247 pages
- 17 ambiguous locations
- 42 image references

Would you like to review the proposed structure before I begin copying?"

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## Constitutional Principle

The resident should have enough capability to fetch any book in the library, enough skill to create new shelves when invited, enough orientation to know where everything belongs, and enough humility to ask before rearranging the house.